



Across US, a race to defend vote



Mail-in ballots are processed at the Chicago Board of Elections in 2024. **ANTONIO PEREZ/TRIBUNE**

WHAT'S NEXT? U.S. District Judge Indira Talwani has scheduled a Sept. 3 hearing on whether to issue a longer-term injunction blocking the new mail-in voting rule. Legal experts expect the challenges to the Postal Service rule and Trump's executive order could ultimately reach the U.S. Supreme Court.

Questioning legality, judge blocks Trump's order on mail voting

By Rick Pearson
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

President Donald Trump's efforts to have the U.S. Postal Service become the final arbiter of who can receive and cast a mail-in ballot have been temporarily blocked by a federal judge who said it was "practically impossible" for states to comply with a "likely unconstitutional regulation" in time for the Nov. 3 general election.

The ruling by U.S. District Judge Indira Talwani in Boston on Thursday night placed a 14-day hold on the Postal Service implementing a March executive order from Trump that gives the USPS power to regulate mail-in voting for the midterm elections.

It is also the latest move in what has been a confusing series of legal

See **JUDGE** on Page A4

In DC, thousands assail court ruling that could limit ballot box access

By Matt Brown
and Matthew Junkroski
ASSOCIATED PRESS

WASHINGTON — Thousands of protesters rallied Friday on the National Mall in support of voting rights and racial justice ahead of the midterm elections, following a wave of changes to voting laws and redistricting that civil rights groups have condemned as detrimental to Black Americans.

The 2026 "Defend the Vote" March on Washington, organized by the Rev. Al Sharpton and Martin Luther King III, echoes the Rev. Martin Luther King Jr.'s 1963 march. The event follows the U.S. Supreme Court's landmark April decision in *Louisiana v. Callais* that reinterpreted key provisions of the Voting Rights Act of 1965, allowing

See **RALLY** on Page A6

No trial for man with long list of ties to mob

'Unusual' deal restricts court from diving into defendant's background

By Jason Meisner
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Robert "Bobby" Dominic has spent a lifetime on Grand Avenue, but always seemingly behind the scenes.

Known for his connections to Richard's Bar, the old-school tavern where the city's smoking ordinances never seem to be enforced, Dominic has reputed Outfit ties that go back many years. FBI records reported he once was a driver for notorious boss Joey "The Clown" Lombardo. The Tribune has reported he allegedly ran pornography and gambling interests for the syndicate. And sources say he has stayed close with current mob leadership.

But Dominic has never been a household name. He has no notable criminal record. And as the old bosses were felled by a series of FBI investigations, he's continued to quietly hold court at Richard's, which is owned by his sister — on paper at least.

So it was fitting that when Dominic appeared at the Dirksen U.S. Courthouse on Friday to plead guilty to a tax charge, there was no big media stir. To the outside observer, the hearing for the soft-spoken man with the graying mustache may have seemed like any other, save for the FBI agents from the public corruption squad sitting in the back.

Then the judge looked closely at the deal that had been struck, which included a provision to proceed straight to sentencing and recommend a short term of probation.

See **DOMINIC** on Page A4

SPORTS

One last time for backups to shine

From wide receivers to offensive tackles, six Bears stand to benefit from a good showing in Saturday's preseason finale against the Titans.

TRIAL AHEAD: Ex-Loretto Hospital executive will remain behind bars for now. **Chicagoland, Page A3**

Nepali, Tibetan communities in Chicago come together to offer support following devastating Himalayan floods that have left thousands missing



'We need to help'

By Finnegan Belleau | CHICAGO TRIBUNE

As word of the devastating floods in Nepal and Tibet began to spread around the world, Nepali leaders in Chicago held a virtual emergency meeting Wednesday night. Over a crowded Facebook Messenger call, they discussed how to best coordinate fundraising efforts for disaster relief.

Thousands of immigrants from Nepal have settled across Chicago and its suburbs, starting nonprofits, opening restaurants and operating businesses. The first-ever Nepali street festival was held Aug. 15, where festivalgoers came to see displays of Nepal's art, music and food in the Edgewater neighborhood.

Now, those leaders are using the strength of their community to organize action.



Above: Rajan Shahi stands Friday in front of a new Edgewater mural commemorating the Nepalese American people living in Chicago. **ARTHUR MAIORELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE** **Top:** Army soldiers help a family disembark from a helicopter Friday after they were rescued from an area hit by flash flooding in Nepal's Nuwakot district. **RAJESH KUMAR SINGH/AP**

In attendance during that online meeting was Shriniwas Kabra, vice president at the Nepali American Center. He said people in the call were from many different organizations and had separate goals, but they agreed to send fundraising money to Nepali government disaster accounts together as one group as they planned traditional and online fundraisers.

Eventually, Kabra said, they would like to collect material goods as well. "Everyone agreed that we need to work together, and we need to help in whatever

way we can," he said.

Nepal and China raced to respond to catastrophic flash floods this week that killed nearly 600 people and left almost 2,500 missing, according to the latest numbers released by the governments and rescue groups. Rescuers on the Nepal-China border were pulling out survivors caked in dark brown mud and helicopters lifted stranded people to safety.

The rescue efforts included a team that rappelled into a

See **FLOODS** on Page A4

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TODAY H: 81 L: 70
SUN. H: 88 L: 72
MON. H: 90 L: 73
FULL WEATHER REPORT, A8

INDEX

Almanac A6
Arts & Living B7
Comics B10-11
Crossword B11
Editorials A5
Horoscope B10
Nation & World B4
Sudoku B11
Television B9

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